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2027 CYCLE

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CUET UG

Political Science

Recent Issues and Challenges

Official Syllabus · Politics in India Since Independence · Class 12 · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

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Syllabus Alignment

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer (NTA CUET(UG) Political Science syllabus 2026, the current 2027 baseline — Politics in India Since Independence)	Skills the questions test
Globalisation & LPG Reforms	Challenge of and responses to globalization: new economic policy and its opposition.	Identifying the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis, structural adjustment policies, and multi-sectoral resistance (trade unions, farmers, cultural critics).
Rise of OBCs in North India	Rise of Other Backward Classes (OBCs) in North Indian politics.	Tracing the political rise of intermediate peasant castes (Yadavs, Kurmis) post-Mandal, and the emergence of regional parties (SP, RJD, JD(U)).
Dalit Politics: Electoral Arena	Dalit politics in the electoral arena: Kanshi Ram and the Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP).	Differentiating BAMCEF (1978), DS-4 (1981), and BSP (1984); analyzing Mayawati's political alliances and social engineering.
Dalit Politics: Non-Electoral Arena	Dalit politics in the non-electoral arena: Dalit Panthers and subaltern assertion.	Recalling Dalit Panthers (1972, Maharashtra, Namdeo Dhasal/J.V. Pawar), literary resistance, and the SC/ST Prevention of Atrocities Act, 1989.
Communalism & Ayodhya Dispute	Challenge of communalism: Ayodhya dispute, 1992 demolition, and communal violence.	Sequencing key events: 1986 court order, 1990 Rath Yatra, 6 December 1992 demolition, imposition of Article 356, and 2002 Gujarat riots.
Debates on Indian Secularism	Secularism in Indian politics: Constitutional model versus communal challenges.	Contrasting Indian 'principled distance' with Western 'wall of separation'; evaluating minority rights and state-sponsored social reform.

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EXAM TIP

High-Scoring Insight & Key Cognitive Traps for CUET UG:

- **Kanshi Ram's Three Organizations:** Do not confuse their sequence or roles: **BAMCEF (1978)** was a non-political employees' federation; **DS-4 (1981)** was an agitational mass forum; and the **Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP, 1984)** was the formal political party to capture state power.
- **Dalit Panthers Origins:** Founded in **May 1972 in Maharashtra** (not UP) by radical writers **Namdeo Dhasal** and **J.V. Pawar**, inspired by the American Black Panther Party.
- **Ayodhya Sequence:** Unlocking of gates (**February 1986** via Faizabad District Court); Somnath-to-Ayodhya Rath Yatra (**September–October 1990**); Demolition of Babri structure (**6 December 1992**); Supreme Court **S.R. Bommai** ruling (**1994**).
- **Western vs. Indian Secularism:** Western secularism mandates a strict "mutual exclusion" or "wall of separation" between church and state. Indian secularism is based on **"principled distance"** (Rajeev Bhargava), allowing the state to reform religious evils (e.g., untouchability, sati) while protecting minority cultural and educational rights (Articles 29 and 30).

1. Challenge of and Responses to Globalisation

In mid-1991, India abandoned four decades of state-dominated economic planning in response to a crippling macroeconomic crisis, embarking on structural integration with the global economy.

The 1991 Balance of Payments Crisis

- **Exhaustion of Foreign Exchange Reserves:** By June 1991, India's foreign exchange reserves plummeted to approximately USD 1USD 1.2 billion, barely sufficient to finance two weeks of essential imports. The sovereign was on the verge of defaulting on international debt obligations.
- **Underlying Macroeconomic Strains:** The crisis was triggered by persistent double-digit fiscal deficits throughout the 1980s, heavy reliance on short-term commercial borrowings, and the sudden outbreak of the Gulf War (1990–1991), which spiked international crude oil prices and halted vital foreign remittances from Indian expatriates in Kuwait and Iraq.
- **Emergency Sovereign Measures:** The caretaker government headed by Prime Minister Chandra Shekhar took the extraordinary emergency measure of physically airlifting 67 tonnes of national gold reserves to the Bank of England and the Union Bank of Switzerland to collateralize bilateral loans and avert a formal sovereign debt default.

The New Economic Policy (NEP) & The Structural Reform Architecture

Following the May–June 1991 general elections, the newly installed Congress government headed by Prime Minister P.V. Narasimha Rao, with distinguished economist Dr. Manmohan Singh as Finance Minister, unveiled historic structural reforms under the framework of **LPG (Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation)**:

- **Liberalisation (Delicensing & Deregulation):** Abolished industrial licensing for almost all industries (except a handful relating to defense, hazardous chemicals, and security), dismantling the stifling "Licence-Permit-Quota Raj".
- **Privatisation (PSU Disinvestment):** Reduced the number of industries reserved exclusively for the public sector from 17 to just 3 (atomic energy, defense equipment, and railway

transport); introduced partial disinvestment of government equity in Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs).

- **Globalisation (Trade & Capital Integration):** Slashed peak customs tariffs from over 300% to under 50%; relaxed foreign exchange controls through full current account convertibility of the Indian Rupee; raised Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) equity limits to 51% (and higher) across major sectors; and joined the World Trade Organization (WTO) as an original founding member on 1 January 1995.

Multi-Dimensional Resistance to Globalisation

The structural economic shift encountered widespread ideological, labor, and grassroots opposition:

- **Trade Union & Organized Labor Opposition:** Central trade unions—principally the All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) and Center of Indian Trade Unions (CITU)—organized nationwide general strikes protesting worker retrenchments, the closure of loss-making public enterprises, the casualization of contract labor, and the erosion of collective bargaining rights.
- **Agrarian & Farmers' Mobilization:**
  - **Karnataka Rajya Raitha Sangha (KRRS):** Led by the charismatic **Prof. M.D. Nanjundaswamy**, the KRRS launched militant direct actions against multinational agribusiness corporations, storming Kentucky Fried Chicken (KFC) outlets and destroying trial plots of genetically modified seeds.
  - **Resistance to WTO & TRIPS:** The Bharatiya Kisan Union (BKU) under Mahendra Singh Tikait and KRRS vehemently opposed the WTO Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS) agreement, rejecting the patenting of indigenous plants, seeds, and biological varieties (such as Neem and Basmati rice) by foreign multinational companies, while demanding the continuation of state agricultural subsidies on fertilizers, power, and irrigation.
- **Cultural & Swadeshi Resistance:** Intellectuals, left-wing cultural forums, and right-wing nationalist groups (such as the **Swadeshi Jagran Manch**) protested against the uninhibited influx of Western consumerism, commercialization of electronic mass media, and vulgarization of public culture, manifesting in protests against international beauty pageants and corporate branding.

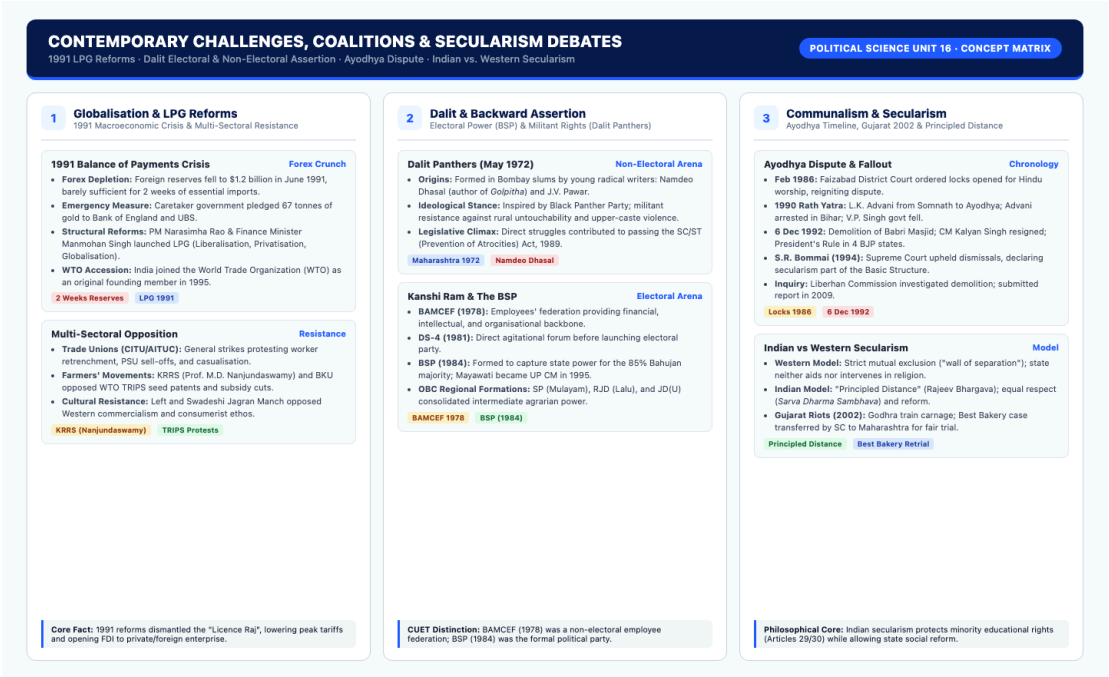


Figure 1: Figure 1 — Contemporary Challenges, Coalitions & Secularism Debates: 1991 LPG reforms, subaltern Dalit assertion, the Ayodhya dispute timeline, and the Indian model of principled distance secularism.

2. Rise of OBCs in North Indian Politics

The implementation of the Mandal Commission recommendations permanently reshaped political representation across the northern Hindi heartland.

Social Background: The Intermediate Peasantry

- **Impact of the Green Revolution:** The Green Revolution in the late 1960s economically enriched middle and intermediate agricultural castes (such as Yadavs, Kurmis, Lodhs, Koeris, and Jats) across Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Haryana, and Rajasthan, transforming them into prosperous agrarian landowners.
- **Disproportionate Political Under-representation:** Despite their substantial demographic strength (roughly 52% of the population) and growing rural economic clout, backward castes occupied fewer than 5% of elite administrative positions (IAS, IPS) and were under-represented in parliamentary leadership.

Post-Mandal Political Mobilization

- **Caste as an Autonomous Electoral Force:** The implementation of 27% OBC reservation in August 1990 by Prime Minister V.P. Singh catalyzed intermediate peasant castes to reject upper-caste Congress hegemony and build their own political vehicles.
- **The Rise of Regional Backward-Caste Formations:**
  - In Uttar Pradesh, **Mulayam Singh Yadav** founded the **Samajwadi Party (SP)** in 1992, uniting intermediate peasant communities (Yadavas) with rural Muslim minorities into an unassailable electoral coalition.
  - In Bihar, **Lalu Prasad Yadav** mobilized the "MY" (Muslim-Yadav) coalition, founding the **Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD)** in 1997 and establishing over a decade of subaltern political dominance.
  - The **Janata Dal (United)** under **Nitish Kumar** consolidated Extremely Backward Castes (EBCs) and non-Yadav peasantry.

- **Deepening Democracy:** The political rise of the OBCs dismantled upper-caste monopoly over legislative assemblies and municipal bodies, transferring substantive democratic power directly to the agrarian majority.

3. Dalit Politics: Electoral Assertion (Kanshi Ram & BSP)

The political emancipation and independent electoral mobilization of India's historically oppressed Scheduled Castes (Dalits) underwent a revolutionary transformation in the 1980s under the leadership of Kanshi Ram.

Kanshi Ram's Three-Tiered Organizational Architecture

Kanshi Ram, a former government research scientist in Pune, realized that unorganized Dalits were treated merely as passive "vote banks" by mainstream parties. He methodically constructed three sequential organizations:

1. **BAMCEF (1978):** The **Backward and Minority Communities Employees Federation** was founded in 1978 as a strictly non-political, non-electoral organization of educated, salaried government employees from SC, ST, OBC, and minority backgrounds. BAMCEF mobilized substantial financial contributions, legal expertise, and administrative intellect to build the core leadership vanguard.
2. **DS-4 (1981):** In 1981, Kanshi Ram established the **Dalit Shoshit Samaj Sangharsh Samiti** (DS-4) as an agitational mass forum. DS-4 organized massive cycle rallies, street theater, and public demonstrations to conscientize the subaltern masses against caste oppression.
3. **Bahujan Samaj Party (1984):** On 14 April 1984 (Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's birth anniversary), Kanshi Ram launched the **Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP)** as a full-fledged electoral party.

The Ideology of "Bahujan" and Mayawati's Premiership

- **The Concept of Bahujan Samaj:** Kanshi Ram broadened the political category beyond Dalits to include Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Other Backward Classes, and religious minorities—proclaiming that these communities constituted **85% of India's population** (**"Bahujan"**), yet were ruled by a 15% upper-caste minority. His rallying slogan declared: **"Jiski jitni sankhya bhaari, uski utni hissedari"** (Proportional power according to population!).
- **Mayawati's Rise to Power:** Under Kanshi Ram's mentorship, schoolteacher-turned-politician **Mayawati** emerged as a formidable mass leader. In June 1995, through a strategic coalition with the Samajwadi Party and outside support from the BJP, Mayawati was sworn in as the **Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh**, becoming the first Dalit woman Chief Minister in Indian history.
- **Social Engineering (Bhaichara Samitis):** In the 2007 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections, Mayawati achieved an outright majority on her own (206 out of 403 seats) by pioneering a pathbreaking "Rainbow Coalition" combining Dalits, Muslims, and upper-caste Brahmins under the slogan of **"Sarvajan Hitaya, Sarvajan Sukhaya"**.

4. Dalit Politics: Non-Electoral Assertion (Dalit Panthers)

While Kanshi Ram pursued electoral power, radical Dalit youth in western India organized militant, non-electoral resistance movements outside the parliamentary framework.

Origins of the Dalit Panthers (May 1972)

- **Founding & Context:** In May 1972, young Dalit intellectuals, poets, and activists in the slums of Bombay, Maharashtra—prominently **Namdeo Dhasal**, **J.V. Pawar**, and **Arjun Dangle**—founded the **Dalit Panthers**.
- **Inspiration:** The organization drew direct inspiration from the militant **Black Panther Party** in the United States, adopting radical mass mobilization, self-defense, and cultural resistance against persistent caste atrocities in rural Maharashtra.
- **Radical Manifesto:** The Dalit Panthers defined the term "Dalit" expansively to include all oppressed peoples—Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, neo-Buddhists, landless laborers, poor peasants, and exploited industrial workers.

Cultural Renaissance and Legislative Achievements

- **Dalit Literature Movement:** Panther leaders revolutionized Marathi literature through gritty, autobiographical, and subaltern poetry exposing the horrors of untouchability and urban ghettoization. Namdeo Dhasal's pathbreaking poetry collection **Golpitha** (1972) received nationwide acclaim.
- **Combating Rural Atrocities:** The Panthers organized direct action squads to defend Dalit communities against upper-caste landlord violence, forced boycotts, and denial of access to village drinking water wells.
- **Legislative Impact:** The persistent mass agitations of the Dalit Panthers and other subaltern organizations forced the Union government to enact the landmark **Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989**, providing stringent legal penalties for caste-based violence, humiliation, and disenfranchisement.
- **Factional Fragmentation:** Despite its immense cultural and social impact, the Dalit Panthers fractured in the late 1970s due to ideological debates between Marxist-oriented leaders (like Dhasal) and Ambedkarite Buddhist purists (like Pawar), splintering into multiple factions of the Republican Party of India (RPI).

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Figure 2: Figure 2 — Contemporary Challenges & Resistance Matrix: The four pillars (Globalisation, OBC rise, Dalit politics, Communalism), Kanshi Ram's organizations, and secularism debates.

5. Challenge of Communalism & The Ayodhya Dispute

The dispute over the 16th-century Babri structure in Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh, emerged as the most polarizing communal controversy in post-independence India.

Chronology of the Ayodhya Controversy

- **The 1949 Event:** On the night of 22–23 December 1949, idols of Lord Ram were clandestinely placed inside the central dome of the Babri Masjid. The district administration locked the premises, declaring the property disputed, while permitting a priest to offer daily rituals.
- **Opening of the Locks (February 1986):** The Faizabad District Judge ordered the locks of the disputed structure opened to the Hindu public for worship. The decision triggered massive communal mobilization on both sides, leading to the formation of the **Babri Masjid Action Committee (BMAC)** by Muslim leaders and the **Ram Janmabhoomi Nyas** by the Vishva Hindu Parishad (VHP).
- **L.K. Advani's Rath Yatra (1990):** In September 1990, BJP President L.K. Advani embarked on a high-profile **Rath Yatra** in a motorized chariot from Somnath in Gujarat towards Ayodhya. Advani's arrest in Bihar by Chief Minister Lalu Prasad Yadav led the BJP to withdraw support from the V.P. Singh government.
- **The Demolition (6 December 1992):** On 6 December 1992, tens of thousands of **Karsevaks** (volunteers) assembled in Ayodhya for a symbolic ritual. The gathering turned violent, stormed the security cordons, and completely demolished the three domes of the Babri structure.
- **The Immediate Political Fallout:**
  - Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister **Kalyan Singh** (BJP) resigned on the evening of 6 December taking moral responsibility.
  - The Central Government dismissed the BJP state governments in Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, and Rajasthan, imposing President's Rule under Article 356.

- Several communal organizations, including the RSS, VHP, and Bajrang Dal, were temporarily banned.
- The Union Government appointed the **Justice M.S. Liberhan Commission of Inquiry** on 16 December 1992 to investigate the demolition (which submitted its report in 2009).

- **Communal Riots:** Demolition was followed by catastrophic communal riots in Mumbai, Surat, Ahmedabad, and Kanpur, claiming over 2,000 lives, followed by the March 1993 serial bomb blasts in Mumbai orchestrated by underworld terror networks.
- **S.R. Bommai Ruling (1994):** In **S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994)**, a 9-judge bench of the Supreme Court upheld the dismissal of the four BJP state governments, ruling that **Secularism is an inviolable basic feature of the Constitution** and that any state government practicing or promoting communal policies is liable to dismissal under Article 356.

6. The 2002 Gujarat Riots

In February–March 2002, large-scale communal violence erupted in the western state of Gujarat:

- **The Godhra Train Carnage (27 February 2002):** Coach S-6 of the Sabarmati Express carrying Hindu pilgrims (**Karsevaks**) returning from Ayodhya was set on fire at Godhra railway station, resulting in the tragic deaths of 59 people, including women and children.
- **The Retaliatory Violence:** Widespread retaliatory violence against the Muslim minority erupted across Gujarat, persisting for over a month. More than 1,000 citizens (predominantly Muslims) were killed, tens of thousands displaced into relief camps, and extensive property and commercial establishments destroyed.
- **Institutional Interventions:**
  - The **National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)** intervened decisively, criticizing the state administration for failing to protect vulnerable citizens and provide adequate relief.
  - **Supreme Court Interventions:** In a landmark intervention to protect the integrity of the judicial process, the Supreme Court transferred key riot trials—most famously the **Best Bakery Case** (Vadodara) and the Bilkis Bano case—outside Gujarat to Maharashtra to ensure that witnesses could testify without fear or intimidation.

7. Debates on Indian Secularism: Western vs. Indian Model

Secularism in Indian constitutional democracy represents a unique, non-Western institutional innovation designed for a deeply religious, plural society.

Contrasting Western and Indian Models of Secularism

Feature	Western (Classic) Model	Indian Constitutional Model
State-Religion Relation	Strict mutual exclusion ("wall of separation"); state neither aids nor intervenes in religion.	"Principled Distance"; state maintains non-discriminatory respect (**Sarva Dharma Sambhava**) and equal distance.
Religious Reform	State cannot intervene in religious customs or reform internal ecclesiastical practices.	State is constitutionally empowered to intervene to eradicate social evils (e.g., untouchability, sati, child marriage).

Feature	Western (Classic) Model	Indian Constitutional Model
Minority Rights	Individual-centric; strictly protects individual citizen rights; skeptical of community-specific rights.	Explicit constitutional minority protections (Articles 29 and 30) guaranteeing linguistic and religious rights.
Financial Subsidies	No public state expenditure on religious establishments or education.	State can grant aid to educational institutions run by religious and linguistic minorities without discrimination.

Political Controversies: The Shah Bano Case (1985)

In 1985, the Supreme Court in **Mohd. Ahmed Khan v. Shah Bano Begum** ruled that a 62-year-old divorced Muslim woman was entitled to maintenance from her former husband under Section 125 of the Criminal Procedure Code (CrPC), emphasizing that gender justice transcends personal religious law:

- **The Political Reaction:** Conservative Muslim organizations protested, viewing the judgment as an unconstitutional interference in Muslim Personal Law (Shariat).
- **The Legislative Rollback:** Under intense political pressure, the Rajiv Gandhi government passed the **Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Divorce) Act, 1986**, which nullified the Supreme Court judgment by restricting maintenance to the **iddat** period.
- **The Secularism Debate:** Critics and opposition parties accused the government of "minority appeasement", pseudo-secularism, and compromising gender equality for electoral vote banks. Defenders stressed the necessity of respecting minority community autonomy.
- **Principled Distance Reaffirmed:** As political philosopher Rajeev Bhargava demonstrates, Indian secularism does not mean hostility toward religion; it practices "principled distance"—intervening when religion infringes on human dignity and equality, while stepping back to protect cultural pluralism and minority survival.

8. Era of Multi-Party Coalitions & The New Political Consensus

The general elections of 1989 marked the formal demise of the 'Congress System' and inaugurated an era of multi-party coalition governance that defined national politics for a quarter of a century (1989–2014).

Structural Transition to Multi-Party Coalition Governance

Between 1952 and 1989, Indian national governance was dominated by single-party rule (primarily the Indian National Congress, interrupted only by the brief Janata Party experiment from 1977 to 1979). The 1989 elections initiated a structural transformation:

- **The End of Single-Party Majority:** No single party won a clear parliamentary majority in the Lok Sabha from 1989 until 2014. National politics transitioned into a bipolar or multipolar coalition framework where alliances were indispensable for forming governments.
- **The National Front (1989–1990):** Headed by V.P. Singh, the National Front government united diverse non-Congress regional and socialist factions. In an unprecedented paradox of external legislative support, it was supported simultaneously from outside by two bitter ideological rivals: the **Left Front** and the **Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)**.
- **The United Front (1996–1998):** Following the brief 13-day Vajpayee government in 1996, the United Front formed a government led by H.D. Deve Gowda (and later I.K. Gujral), backed from the outside by the Congress party and the Left Front.
- **The National Democratic Alliance (NDA, 1998–2004):** Led by Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, the NDA became the first non-Congress coalition government to complete a full

five-year term in office (1999–2004), demonstrating the viability and institutional stability of pre-poll multi-party coalitions governed by a Common Minimum Programme.

- **The United Progressive Alliance (UPA, 2004–2014):** Under Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, the UPA governed for two consecutive terms (2004–2009 supported from outside by the Left Front, and 2009–2014), passing rights-based social welfare legislations including MGNREGA (2005) and the Right to Information (RTI) Act (2005).

The Four Pillars of the Post-1990 Political Consensus

Despite intense rhetorical electoral competition and deep partisan rivalries, political scientists identify a broad four-fold consensus that crystallized across major national and regional political parties:

1. **Consensus on New Economic Policies:** While political parties in opposition frequently criticize privatization and deregulation, successive governments (Congress, United Front, NDA, UPA) sustained economic reforms, liberalization, foreign direct investment, and infrastructure modernization.
2. **Acceptance of the Social and Political Claims of Backward Classes:** All major political formations accepted the constitutional legitimacy and political necessity of reservations for Other Backward Classes (OBCs) in educational institutions and public employment.
3. **Acceptance of the Central Role of State-Level Parties:** The historical suspicion of regional parties as 'parochial' or 'anti-national' dissolved. Regional parties (DMK, AIADMK, TDP, SP, RJD, BJD, Trinamool Congress) established themselves as indispensable power brokers and national coalition partners, deepening federal democracy.
4. **Pragmatic Alliances over Ideological Dogmatism:** Coalition governance replaced rigid ideological exclusivity with pragmatic governance based on common minimum agendas, power-sharing pacts, and post-poll realpolitik.

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Chapter Synthesis & Cognitive Mindmap

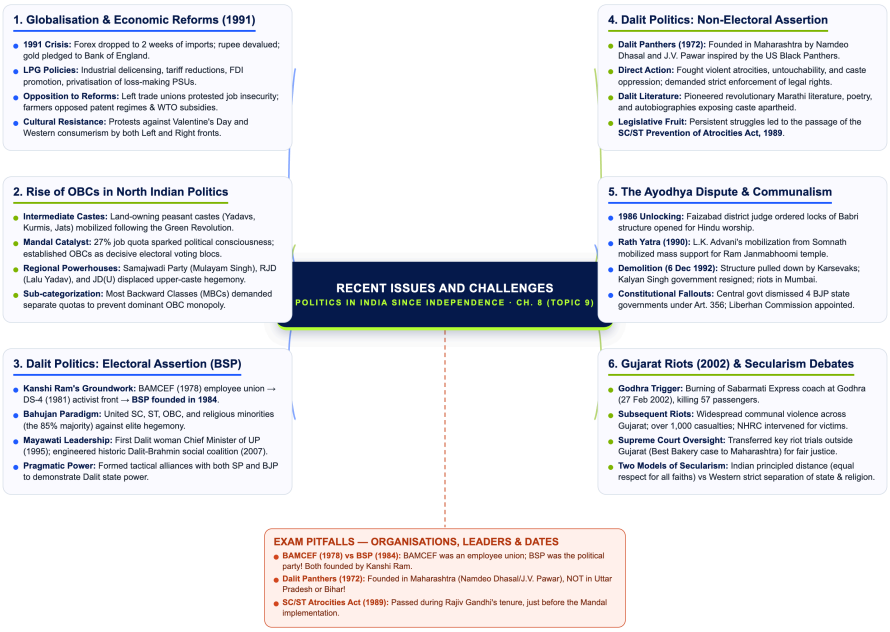


Figure 3: Figure 3 — Recent Issues and Challenges Mindmap: Complete structural map of 1991 LPG reforms, intermediate caste rise, Kanshi Ram and Dalit Panthers, Ayodhya dispute, Gujarat riots, and Indian secularism.

HIGH-YIELD MEMORY HOOKS & HISTORIOGRAPHICAL POINTERS

- **1991 Macro Crisis:** Foreign reserves fell to **USD 1USD 1.2 billion** (barely 2 weeks of imports); 67 tonnes gold pledged; **Narasimha Rao & Manmohan Singh** launched LPG.
- **Farmers' Resistance to WTO: Karnataka Rajya Raitha Sangha (KRRS)** led by **Prof. M.D. Nanjundaswamy** opposed WTO TRIPS seed patents.
- **Kanshi Ram's Triad: BAMCEF (1978)** [employees], **DS-4 (1981)** [agitational wing], **Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP, 1984)** [electoral party].
- **Mayawati Landmark:** Sworn in as **Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh** in **June 1995**; first Dalit woman Chief Minister in India.
- **Dalit Panthers (May 1972):** Founded in **Maharashtra** by writers **Namdeo Dhasal** (wrote **Golpitha**) and **J.V. Pawar**; inspired **Atrocities Act (1989)**.
- **Ayodhya Timeline: Feb 1986** (locks opened); **1990** (Advani Rath Yatra); **6 Dec 1992** (Babri Masjid demolition); **Kalyan Singh** resigned.
- **Inquiry Commission: Justice M.S. Liberhan Commission** investigated the Ayodhya demolition (submitted report in 2009).
- **S.R. Bommai (1994):** Supreme Court ruled that **Secularism is part of the Basic Structure**; upheld dismissal of four BJP state governments.
- **Gujarat Riots (2002):** Sparked by **Godhra train fire** (59 dead); Supreme Court transferred **Best Bakery trial** to Maharashtra.
- **Indian Secularism:** Based on **Principled Distance** and equal respect (**Sarva Dharma Sambhava**), contrasting with Western "wall of separation".

MASTER STRATEGY CHEATSHEET — RECENT ISSUES & CHALLENGES

▸**Globalisation & 1991 LPG Reforms:** Balance of Payments crisis (USD 1.2 billion reserves, 2 wks imports) → Structural adjustments (LPG) → Resistance: Trade unions (CITU/AITUC), Farmers (KRRS & Nanjundaswamy against TRIPS), Swadeshi platforms. ▸**Subaltern Assertiveness:**

- **OBC Mobilisation:** Post-Mandal rise of intermediate agrarian castes → Regional parties: SP (Mulayam), RJD (Lalu), JD(U) (Nitish).
- **Dalit Electoral Resurgence:** Kanshi Ram creates BAMCEF (1978), DS-4 (1981), BSP (1984) → 85% Bahujan coalition → Mayawati becomes UP CM in 1995.
- **Dalit Panthers (1972, Maharashtra):** Namdeo Dhasal (**Golpitha**) & J.V. Pawar → Militant struggle → SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act 1989.

▸**Communalism & The Ayodhya Dispute:**

- Dec 1949 (idols placed) → Feb 1986 (locks opened) → 1990 Advani Rath Yatra → 6 Dec 1992 Demolition → Kalyan Singh resigns → Art 356 in 4 states → Liberhan Commission.
- **S.R. Bommai (1994):** Secularism is Basic Structure; Art 356 dismissals validated.

▸**Gujarat Violence (2002):** Godhra Sabarmati Express coach S-6 (27 Feb 2002) → NHRC intervention → SC transfers Best Bakery case to Maharashtra. ▸**Secularism Debates:** Western "strict wall of separation" vs Indian "principled distance" (Rajeev Bhargava) & **Sarva Dharma Sambhava** → Shah Bano case (1985).

THE SEVEN FATAL CUET TRAPS

1. **BAMCEF vs BSP:** BAMCEF (1978) was a **non-political employee federation**; the BSP (1984) was the formal **electoral political party**.
2. **Dalit Panthers Location:** Founded in **Maharashtra** (Bombay slums) in 1972, NOT in Uttar Pradesh or Bihar.
3. **Opening of Locks Date:** The Faizabad Court ordered the locks opened in **February 1986**, NOT in 1992 (the year of demolition).
4. **CM Resignation on 6 Dec 1992: Kalyan Singh** was the ruling BJP Chief Minister who resigned, NOT Mulayam Singh Yadav (who was in opposition).
5. **Inquiry Commission for Ayodhya:** The **Liberhan Commission** investigated the Babri demolition; the **Nanavati Commission** probed 1984 & 2002 Godhra.
6. **Best Bakery Case Venue:** The Supreme Court transferred the trial from Gujarat to **Maharashtra** to guarantee a free and fair judicial trial.
7. **Nature of Indian Secularism:** It is NOT passive or strictly separated; it practices **principled distance**, permitting state social reform while safeguarding minority rights.

Practice Questions (Exam Pattern)

Fifteen authentic CUET UG examination-standard multiple-choice questions testing conceptual, chronological, institutional, and factual mastery. Marking scheme: +5 for correct answer, −1 for incorrect attempt.

Part 1: Globalisation, Farmers' Resistance & Subaltern Mobilisation

Q1. In June 1991, roughly how much foreign exchange reserves remained with the Indian government, triggering the adoption of the New Economic Policy (LPG)?

(A) Barely USD 1.2 billion, sufficient for only about two weeks of essential imports
(B) Nearly 6 months of essential imports
(C) Over 1 year of imports
(D) Sufficient for 3 months of imports

Sol. Q1. By June 1991, India's foreign currency reserves dropped to barely USD 1USD 1.2 billion, adequate for only about two weeks of essential imports, forcing structural LPG economic reforms. **Answer: (A)**

Q2. Which prominent farmers' leader headed the Karnataka Rajya Raitha Sangha (KRRS) in militant direct actions against WTO patent regimes and multinational seed corporations?

(A) Mahendra Singh Tikait
(B) Sharad Joshi
(C) Prof. M.D. Nanjundaswamy
(D) Chaudhary Charan Singh

Sol. Q2. Prof. M.D. Nanjundaswamy led the Karnataka Rajya Raitha Sangha (KRRS) in high-profile agitations against WTO intellectual property rules, multinational corporations, and seed patenting. **Answer: (C)**

Q3. Which organization was established by Kanshi Ram in 1978 as a non-electoral federation of government employees from backward and minority communities?

(A) Dalit Shoshit Samaj Sangharsh Samiti (DS-4)
(B) Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP)
(C) BAMCEF (Backward and Minority Communities Employees Federation)
(D) Dalit Panthers

Sol. Q3. Kanshi Ram established BAMCEF in 1978 as a non-electoral body of salaried public sector employees to build an intellectual, organizational, and financial base. **Answer: (C)**

Q4. The militant social organization 'Dalit Panthers', inspired by the Black Panther movement in the US, was founded in May 1972 in which Indian state?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Bihar
(D) Punjab

Sol. Q4. The Dalit Panthers was founded in Maharashtra (specifically in the slums of Bombay) in May 1972 by young writers and activists resisting entrenched rural caste atrocities. **Answer: (B)**

Q5. Who was the renowned Marathi poet and co-founder of the Dalit Panthers who authored the revolutionary poetry collection 'Golpitha'?

(A) Namdeo Dhasal
(B) Kanshi Ram
(C) Ram Vilas Paswan
(D) B.R. Ambedkar

Sol. Q5. Namdeo Dhasal, a pathbreaking Marathi poet who wrote 'Golpitha', co-founded the Dalit Panthers alongside J.V. Pawar and Arjun Dangle in 1972. **Answer: (A)**

Part 2: Ayodhya Dispute, Judicial Rulings & Communalism

Q6. In which year did the Faizabad District Court order the opening of the locks of the disputed Babri structure in Ayodhya to allow Hindu devotees to offer worship?

(A) 1949 (B) February 1986
(C) 1990 (D) December 1992

Sol. Q6. In February 1986, the Faizabad District Judge ordered the locks of the Babri structure opened for Hindu worship, an event that escalated religious mobilization on both sides. **Answer: (B)**

Q7. Who was the Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh who resigned on the evening of 6 December 1992 following the demolition of the Babri Masjid?

(A) Mulayam Singh Yadav (B) Kalyan Singh
(C) Mayawati (D) Rajnath Singh

Sol. Q7. Kalyan Singh headed the BJP state government in Uttar Pradesh; he submitted his resignation to the Governor on the evening of 6 December 1992 after the structure was demolished. **Answer: (B)**

Q8. Which judicial inquiry commission was appointed by the Government of India in December 1992 to investigate the sequence of events leading to the demolition of the Babri Masjid?

(A) Shah Commission (B) Sarkaria Commission
(C) Nanavati Commission (D) The Justice M.S. Liberhan Commission

Sol. Q8. The Justice M.S. Liberhan Commission of Inquiry was constituted in December 1992 to probe the Babri Masjid demolition; it submitted its report in 2009. **Answer: (D)**

Q9. In which landmark judgment did a nine-judge bench of the Supreme Court uphold the dismissal of four BJP state governments in 1992, ruling that 'Secularism is part of the Basic Structure'?

(A) Kesavananda Bharati Case (1973) (B) Indra Sawhney Case (1992)
(C) S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994) (D) Minerva Mills Case (1980)

Sol. Q9. In S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994), a nine-judge constitutional bench ruled that secularism is a fundamental feature of the basic structure, validating the dismissal of four state governments. **Answer: (C)**

Q10. Following the communal violence in Gujarat in 2002, the Supreme Court of India famously ordered which high-profile riot trial to be transferred outside Gujarat to Maharashtra to ensure an unbiased trial?

(A) The Best Bakery Case (B) Godhra Sabarmati Express Trial
(C) Gulbarg Society Case (D) Naroda Patiya Case

Sol. Q10. In the Best Bakery Case (Vadodara), the Supreme Court ordered a retrial outside Gujarat in Maharashtra to ensure fair, uninfluenced proceedings for victim-witness Zahira Sheikh. **Answer: (A)**

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Part 3: Secularism Models, Legal Cases & Contemporary Challenges

Q11. How does the Indian constitutional model of secularism fundamentally differ from the classic Western (American/French) model of secularism?

(A) The Indian model completely outlaws all forms of private religious practice
(B) The Western model allows the state to manage temples and churches, while India does not
(C) The Indian model establishes a state-sponsored national religion
(D) The Indian model is characterized by 'principled distance' and equal respect for all religions (Sarva Dharma Sambhava) permitting state intervention for social reform, whereas the Western model mandates strict mutual exclusion and a rigid wall of separation

Sol. Q11. Indian secularism practices 'principled distance' and equal respect (Sarva Dharma Sambhava), allowing state intervention for progressive social reform, unlike the strict Western separation of church and state. **Answer: (D)**

Q12. The Shah Bano Case (1985), which sparked intense political debate over secularism and uniform civil laws, pertained to:

(A) A divorced Muslim woman's constitutional right to claim maintenance from her husband under Section 125 of the Criminal Procedure Code
(B) A dispute over the ownership of religious waqf properties
(C) The introduction of reservations for religious minorities in government jobs
(D) The ban on triple talaq by an executive ordinance

Sol. Q12. In Mohd. Ahmed Khan v. Shah Bano Begum (1985), the Supreme Court ruled that a divorced Muslim woman was entitled to maintenance under Section 125 of the CrPC, affirming gender justice. **Answer: (A)**

Q13. Which landmark legislation was enacted by Parliament in 1989 to prevent atrocities and crimes against members of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, fulfilling a major demand of the Dalit movement?

(A) The Protection of Civil Rights Act
(B) The Untouchability Offences Act
(C) The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989
(D) The Maintenance of Internal Security Act

Sol. Q13. The SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 was enacted to provide stringent legal penalties against caste violence, humiliation, and atrocities, fulfilling a central demand of Dalit movements. **Answer: (C)**

Q14. In the 1990s, which three Hindi heartland regional parties emerged as the primary vehicles of intermediate backward caste (OBC) political power?

(A) DMK, AIADMK, and PMK
(B) Samajwadi Party (SP), Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD), and Janata Dal (United) [JD(U)]
(C) Shiromani Akali Dal, National Conference, and TDP
(D) Asom Gana Parishad, BJD, and Trinamool Congress

Sol. Q14. The Samajwadi Party (UP), Rashtriya Janata Dal (Bihar), and Janata Dal (United) emerged as the dominant regional political parties articulating the interests of the agrarian backward classes. **Answer: (B)**

Q15. In the 2002 Godhra train incident, which tragedy served as the immediate trigger for widespread communal violence across the state of Gujarat?

(A) A bomb blast in an Ahmedabad commercial market
(B) The demolition of a religious shrine in Vadodara
(C) A political assassination during an election rally
(D) The burning of coach S-6 of the Sabarmati Express at Godhra railway station carrying Karsevaks, resulting in the death of 59 persons

Sol. Q15. The burning of coach S-6 of the Sabarmati Express on 27 February 2002 at Godhra, which killed 59 people including Karsevaks, ignited retaliatory communal violence across Gujarat. **Answer: (D)**

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